

Facilitator guide — Slide Decks

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About these activities

Slide Decks teaches participants to assemble what they have built — charts and interpretations — into a presentation. It is a **build-then-polish arc**: create the deck container, see the editor demoed, then add charts two ways and finalise.

Four handouts. ~60 min of participant time, plus a ~5 min facilitator demo (editor walkthrough — script in the appendix).

How to run it

- The sequence is **container** → **demo** → **do (manual)** → **do (AI)** → **polish**. Slide 1 sets up the deck and teaches slide types; you then run the editor demo (appendix) live before participants touch the editor themselves.
- The **editor walkthrough demo** is the gating moment for activities 2 and 3 — without it participants will not know how to add a viz or split a slide into chart + text. Run the appendix script as written.
- Activities 2 and 3 are the same task two ways: the handouts re-explain what you demoed. They are not self-teaching scripts.

The activities

1. Create your first slide deck

Activity · ~10 min

What it is — a short activity creating the deck container and a first content slide. Also teaches the **three slide types**.

What the handout covers — open the personal folder, + Create slide deck and name it, Add slide, choose between **Cover** (title page), **Section** (divider) and **Content** (chart + text) — pick Content.

Watch for — participants create the deck *outside* their personal folder, or pick Cover/Section instead of Content — leaving them with nothing editable for the chart activities that follow.

Run the editor demo here — before activity 2. Use the appendix script.

2. Add a visualisation (manually)

Activity · ~15 min

What it is — a hands-on activity adding a saved chart to a slide via the editor menus, repeating what you just demoed.

What the handout covers — open the deck, click into the content slide, Block → Visualisation → Select, pick a chart the participant created, save.

Watch for — participants try to rebuild charts inside the slide editor. Reinforce **"reuse, don't recreate"**; a missing chart simply isn't saved in a visible Visualisations folder.

3. Add a visualisation (with the AI Assistant)

Activity · ~15 min

What it is — a hands-on activity adding a saved chart to a deck via an AI prompt.

What the handout covers — prompt the AI to surface a saved visualisation, use the chat preview's "Add to slide deck" button, ending with a two-slide deck.

Watch for — the AI can only find charts already saved in Visualisations. If it returns the wrong chart or no "Add to deck" button, participants must save first and name the chart more specifically.

4. Edit and finalise your slides

Activity · ~20 min

What it is — a polishing activity reviewing and finalising every slide in the deck.

What the handout covers — four passes per slide (accuracy review, resize text boxes, resize/reposition charts, adjust layout/spacing); slides can be sent back to the AI for rewrites.

Watch for — the resize divider only appears after clicking into a slide. A chart still cramped after resizing needs to be simplified back in the **Visualisations** tab, not in the slide editor.

Wrapping up

By the end, every participant has a saved, polished two-slide deck. The bar to hold them to: each slide could be shown to a Director without an apology.

Appendix — Editor walkthrough demo script

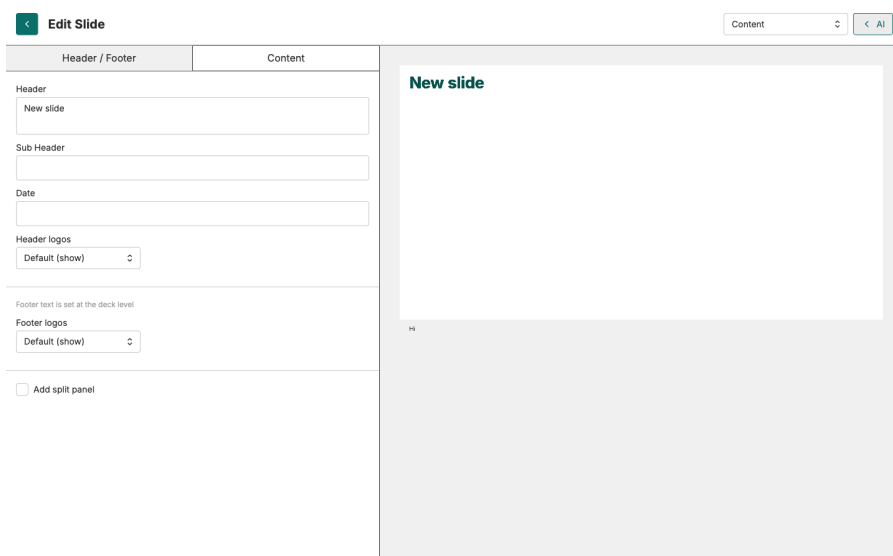
A 5-minute live tour of the slide editor. Participants have just created an empty content slide; this demo shows them how to put a chart and text on it, before they repeat it themselves in activity 2. Don't extend it — keep momentum.

Setup checklist

- ☐ A slide deck open with one **empty content slide** ready
- ☐ At least one saved visualisation in the demo account
- ☐ Browser zoom set to ~100% so participants can see UI clearly
- ☐ Screen-share working if remote

Step 1 — Open the editor

- **Do:** Click the empty content slide in the slide list.
- **Say:** *"Clicking the slide opens the editor. The preview is on the right; the editing options are on the left."*
- **Watch for:** Participants ask "where's the editor?" — answer: it's not a separate window, it's the right-hand pane that just appeared.



Step 2 — Add a visualisation block

- **Do:** **Block** → **Visualisation** → **Select visualisation** → pick a saved chart → **Select**. The chart fills the slide.
- **Say:** *"This is how you put a saved chart on a slide. You're not building a new chart here — you're picking one you already saved in the Visualisations tab."*
- **Watch for:** Reinforce **"reuse, don't recreate"** — the chart must already be saved in Visualisations. If a participant's chart isn't appearing in the picker, they need to go back and save it there first.

Step 3 — Split the slide into chart + text

- **Do:** Right-click in the slide preview → **Add → Col to right** → click into the new text column and type a one-line takeaway.
- **Say:** *"Two columns is the FASTR pattern: chart on one side, the one thing you want the reader to take away on the other. If you need more, split into another slide."*
- **Watch for:** Participants try to fit four columns. Steer them back to two — extra content goes on the next slide.

 **Right-click menu showing "Add → Col to right"**

`resources/screenshots/m9d/col_to_right_menu.png`

Step 4 — Resize the chart and text areas

- **Do:** Hover the vertical divider between the chart and text columns. Cursor changes to a resize handle. Drag left or right.
- **Say:** *"Drag this to give the chart more room or the text more room. Both resize automatically."*
- **Watch for:** Participants who didn't notice the cursor change — point it out explicitly.

Step 5 — Edit slide details and save

- **Do:** Switch to the **Slide** tab → edit the slide title and subtitle. Switch to **Header/Footer** → date and footer. Save.
- **Say:** *"The Slide tab is the headline of the slide. Content is the text columns. Header/Footer is the small text at the bottom. Save when done — there's autosave but Save is your safety net."*
- **Watch for:** Participants ask whether they should edit text directly or go back to the AI — answer: small fixes here, structural rewrites go back to the AI.

Common questions

Q: Can I undo a resize?

A: Yes — Ctrl/Cmd-Z, or drag the divider back. Edits are not destructive.

Q: Does the editor save automatically?

A: Yes. The Save button is a manual safety net for major changes.

Q: Can I change the slide order in the editor?

A: No — slide ordering lives in the deck view. Drag slides in the slide list.

Backup plan